Tilmann Waffenschmidt

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Research Interests

Political Economy, Development Economics, Economic History, Migration

Current Position

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics
Chair of International and Development Politics, Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Axel Dreher Sep 2023 – present
Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg, Germany

Education

University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong Sep 2025 – Nov 2025
Visiting Ph.D. Student; Host: Prof. Austin Strange

University of Mannheim, Mannheim, Germany 2023
Ph.D. coursework, Graduate School of Economic and Social Sciences (GESS)

University of Texas at Dallas, Richardson, TX, USA 2022 – 2023
Philipps University of Marburg, Marburg, Germany 2021 – 2022
Master of Science in International Political Economy (Double Degree), GPA: 4.0/4.0

HTW Berlin, Berlin, Germany 2020 – 2021
Master of Arts in International and Development Economics, GPA: 3.3/4.0

Stellenbosch University, Stellenbosch, South Africa 2019
Semester abroad

University of Hamburg, Hamburg, Germany 2016 – 2020
Bachelor of Arts in Socioeconomics, GPA: 3.6/4.0

Work in Progress

Talk Shows, Populism, and the Far Right: Evidence from Germany's Political Talk-Show Universe, 1998–2025

The Loyalty Paradox: Ethnic Mobilization, Public Resources, and Electoral Strategy in Sub-Saharan Africa, with Cäcilia Stapper

Pressure at Home, Presence Abroad: Development Projects and Chinese Mobility to Africa
with Tobias Heidland, Annika Kaiser, Linda Lochner, and Song Yuan

Ballots, Borders, and Election Cycles: How Elections Influence Migration Politics

Globalization and Discontent: How Globalization Fuels Political Polarization
with Valentin Lang

Seeds of Change: Dietary Composition and Cultural Evolution in Early Human Societies
with Tobias Korn

From Capitol Hill to Ancestral Homes: Diasporas and U.S. Foreign Aid
with Anika Khan

The Pope: Moral Evaluation and Social Responsibility
with Andreas Fuchs and Robin Möllerherm

Other Professional Experience

Student Research Assistant Dec 2021 – Aug 2023
Philipps University of Marburg, Research Group "Sustainable Use of Natural Resources"

Research Intern Aug 2020 – Oct 2020
German Institute for Global and Area Studies (GIGA), Germany

Intern Aug 2018 – Oct 2018
Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung, Lusaka, Zambia

Intern Jun 2016
German Bundestag, Berlin, Germany

Voluntary Service Sep 2015 – Mar 2016
Hospital in Asunción, Paraguay

Teaching and Supervision

Supervision at Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg 2024 – present

Research Seminar Political Economy and Development Economics
Bachelor and Master; Organizer in 2025; 8 seminar papers supervised

Bachelor's theses (3), Master's theses (2)

Teaching Assistant at Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg 2024 – present

Introduction to Macroeconomics

Teaching Assistant at Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg 2024 – 2025

Empirical Public Choice

Teaching Assistant at HTW Berlin 2021

Macroeconomics and Development

Teaching Assistant at HTW Berlin 2021

International Economics of the 21st Century

Conference and Seminar Presentations of Research

2026

Beyond Basic Questions Workshop, Marburg
Talk Shows, Populism, and the Far Right
The Loyalty Paradox[*]
Pressure at Home, Presence Abroad[*]

German Development Economics Conference and 1st EDEG Conference, Kiel
The Loyalty Paradox (poster)

European Public Choice Society Annual Meeting, Madrid
Ballots, Borders, and Election Cycles
The Loyalty Paradox[*]

2025

Workshop "Politics of International Development", University of Hong Kong
Ballots, Borders, and Election Cycles

University of Haifa
Ballots, Borders, and Election Cycles

Beyond Basic Questions Workshop, Regensburg
Ballots, Borders, and Election Cycles

[*] Presented by a coauthor.

Scholarships and Funding

Doctoral Scholarship, Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung (∼ 75,000 €) 2025 – 2028

Ph.D. in Political Economy, Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg

PROMOS Scholarship, Philipps University of Marburg / DAAD (∼ 1,400 €) 2022 – 2023

Study abroad, University of Texas at Dallas

Scholarship, Stiftung der Deutschen Wirtschaft (sdw) (∼ 7,000 €) 2020 – 2021

M.A. International and Development Economics, HTW Berlin

Scholarship, Stiftung der Deutschen Wirtschaft (sdw) (∼ 17,000 €) 2016 – 2020

B.A. Socioeconomics, University of Hamburg

Summer Schools

Barcelona School of Economics 2025

Difference-in-Differences with Panel Data
Lecturer: Jeffrey M. Wooldridge

Centre for Economic Policy Research (CEPR) 2024

Twenty-third Summer School in International and Development Economics (Gargonza, Italy)
Lecturers: Claudio Ferraz & Sandra Sequeira

Nova School of Business and Economics 2024

Development Economics: Practical Issues in Designing and Analyzing Field Experiments
Lecturer: David McKenzie

Civic Engagement

Organization of events, d|carb Future Economy Forum 2021

Deputy Chair, Jusos Hamburg-Altona 2018 – 2019

Member of the Executive Committee, Jusos Hamburg-Altona 2017 – 2019

Member of the Executive Committee, SPD Flottbek-Othmarschen 2017 – 2019

Treasurer, Amnesty International University Group 2017 – 2019

Skills

Programming & Software: Stata, R, EViews, LaTeX, MS Office

Languages: German (native), English (fluent), French (basic), Spanish (basic)

References

Prof. Dr. Axel Dreher
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Prof. Dr. Andreas Fuchs
University of Göttingen
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Prof. Dr. Tobias Heidland
Kiel Institute for the World Economy
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